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Workforce Engagement Management (WEM) covers the software that schedules, measures, coaches and assists contact-centre staff, and increasingly the AI agents working beside them.

This week's main developments

- Microsoft published cost estimates for the contact-centre AI it sells on rivals' platforms. It counts credits per conversation, and per turn for live coaching, not per user or per resolved issue.
- Microsoft's chief executive said its business model is moving from per-seat subscriptions "to include consumption". Microsoft no longer reports Dynamics 365 growth on its own.
- Sierra says its annual recurring revenue passed $400 million, after adding more than $150 million in the third quarter. These are Sierra's own, unaudited figures.
- Fin's price page now lists voice at $1.99 per resolved call. It says a reopened conversation is refunded and a customer asking for a human costs nothing.
- Comcast filed layoff notices in four states, local press reports. By our sum they cover 994 roles, most at its head office. Comcast also plans more than 1,100 new positions.
- New York City moved the hearing on its proposed bot rule to 18 December. Comments now close the same day.

Microsoft prices its contact-centre AI by the conversation

- Microsoft's Copilot Credits guide, dated November 2026, gives "rough planning estimates" for Contact Center Intelligence. That is the product Microsoft sells on top of other vendors' contact centres.
- Microsoft says its Customer Assist Agent both resolves issues by itself and "assists representatives during live interactions".
- That agent uses 2 to 5 credits for a short chat, 10 to 15 for a voice call with lookups, and 20 to 25 for a long voice flow that hands off to a person.
- Its quality agent uses 5 to 10 credits to score a finished conversation. Live coaching on every turn uses 10 to 20 credits per turn.
- Microsoft lists pay-as-you-go credits at $0.01 each. By our arithmetic, a medium voice call costs about $0.10 to $0.15 at list price, and coaching costs $0.10 to $0.20 per turn.
- Microsoft said on 21 October that live coaching and help for human agents are "available soon". By our reading, the guide prices them before they ship.
- **Our view:** buyers now get a cost per conversation for Microsoft's AI running beside another vendor's per-seat contact centre. On a long call, live coaching could cost more than the AI agent itself.

Microsoft's results: seats plus consumption

- Microsoft's chief executive, Satya Nadella, said on 28 October: "Our business model is expanding from per-seat subscriptions to include consumption".
- He said the number of Copilot customers paying through usage billing "grew over 75 percent over the quarter".
- Microsoft now reports Dynamics 365 inside a new "Industry solutions cloud" line, with LinkedIn's hiring and sales tools and its healthcare cloud. That line grew 10%.
- Its finance chief, Amy Hood, said "bookings trends continued to moderate". She guided to growth in the "mid to high-single digits" next quarter.
- In July, Microsoft reported Dynamics 365 alone growing 13%. The two figures do not cover the same products.
- The call transcript does not mention the contact centre.
- **Our view:** investors can no longer see whether Microsoft's contact-centre push moves Dynamics 365 growth. Its roadmap and price guides are now the main public evidence.

Sierra reports $400 million in annual recurring revenue

- Sierra wrote on 30 October: "This week, we hit $400M+ in ARR, adding over $150M+ in ARR in Q3 alone." ARR means annual recurring revenue.
- Sierra says it took five months to double from $200 million to $400 million. It says it works with "almost 50% of the Fortune 50".
- Sierra restated that customers "pay for outcomes", and named loans refinanced, claims paid and sales closed as examples.
- Sierra says more than 50 enterprises, including Shopify, Stripe and Walmart, now develop the personal-agent protocol it leads with Meta. It named 35 design partners on 9 October. The protocol has no tagged release.
- On 28 October Sierra launched a Compliance Console for outbound calls by AI agents. It sets contact windows, frequency limits, opt-outs and disclosures.
- Sierra also joined Google Cloud Marketplace on 26 October, so qualifying purchases count toward Google Cloud commitments.
- **Our view:** Sierra's examples are moving from answering service contacts to outbound sales and collections. Its revenue figures remain its own.

Fin tightens what counts as a paid outcome

- Fin's price page still charges $0.99 per outcome. Between 25 October and 2 November it added "Fin Voice is available via sales at $1.99 per voice outcome".

- The page now says: “If the conversation is later reopened, the outcome is refunded.”
- It also says that if Fin cannot help, “or if at any point the customer asks to speak to a human, you pay nothing.”
- Copilot, Fin’s assistant for human agents, is now $29 per agent a month billed annually, or $35 monthly. On 25 October the page showed $35 per user.
- The $9.99 price per qualified sales lead no longer appears on Fin’s site. Intercom’s own price page still shows it.
- **Our view:** the main per-outcome price list now favours the buyer on refunds and human requests. That answers a common objection that outcome prices pay for silence.

Comcast files layoff notices in four states

- Comcast is laying off 634 employees at its Philadelphia headquarters from 31 December, the Philadelphia Inquirer reports, citing the state notice.
- The Inquirer reports further notices for 119 roles in New Jersey, 159 in Washington state and 82 in California. By our sum, that is 994 roles.
- Comcast plans to hire for “more than 1,100 new positions”, including more than 500 in Philadelphia, the Inquirer reports, citing the notice.
- In Washington, “Construction jobs are the largest group”, MyNorthwest reports. The only customer-service roles it names are “customer experience supervisors”.
- Comcast’s statement says it is “fundamentally redesigning our organization”. As quoted, it does not mention AI.
- **Our view:** on 22 October Comcast tied lower contact volume to its AI suppliers. The first noticed cuts fall mostly on other functions. State notices cover only larger cuts, so this is a minimum.

New York City moves its bot-rule hearing to 18 December

- New York City’s rules website now lists the public hearing on the automated customer service rule for 18 December at 11:00. On 25 October it showed 19 November.
- The same page says comments close on 18 December. Two law firms, Wiley and a JD Supra author, also give 18 December.
- The notice itself still prints 19 November; it has not been reissued. The proposal’s content is unchanged.
- **Our view:** the rule cannot be adopted before the hearing, so the earliest adoption moves back by a month.
- **Watch:** the hearing on 18 December.

Scheduling: AI suggests, planners still decide

- Talkdesk began rolling out AI suggestions to move agents' breaks during the day on 29 October. They respond to live queue conditions.
- Planners accept or reject each suggestion, or accept all at once for a team or for every team. Talkdesk lists it as a preview for selected customers.
- Assembled posted a job advert on 27 October for an AI agent that "recommends or takes action" during the day. It says agents may "eventually autonomously make" these decisions.
- Assembled calls this a new product area. It is a hiring plan, not a product.
- Microsoft's two scheduling features due in October, both alerts only, were still "In development" on 2 November. Its self-acting Intraday Agent is still listed for March 2027.
- Lorikeet and Aspect still describe their live automatic modes as not yet available.
- Three vendors added or previewed shift bidding within eight days: Talkdesk, Assembled and Cisco Webex. Assembled lets firms rank agents by "seniority, performance, or another company policy".
- **Our view:** the shipped frontier is software that drafts schedule changes for a planner to approve in bulk. As far as we can tell, no tracked tool yet acts by itself when demand shifts.

Bigger partners now sell AI agents

- SAP now resells Parloa's platform as "SAP Conversational Agent Management by Parloa", Parloa announced on 26 October. On 28 October Parloa and McKinsey announced an alliance.
- Decagon launched a partner programme on 30 October. It says it is on the AWS, Google Cloud, Databricks and OpenAI marketplaces, where customers "can apply existing commitments".
- Decagon also says "More than 80% of traffic on Decagon runs through models built in-house". There was no news on its reported sale.
- Cresta opened its agent platform to customers' own developers on 29 October. Outsourcers TELUS Digital and Atento are quoted as building AI agents on it.
- **Our view:** large buyers can now pay for these agents from budgets they already hold with SAP and the cloud providers. Outsourcers are building on specialist platforms rather than only reselling suites.

AI agents planned and scored like staff

- RingCentral says its RingCX contact centre now forecasts staffing "across AI and human agent capacity together", and scores AI agents "against the same rubric used for human agents". It showed both at a trade show on 28 October, with no ship date or price.
- Cisco Webex added reporting on AI agents' containment, escalation and error rates on 26 October.

- Microsoft added a roadmap entry on 28 October for checking AI agents' quality. It says the feature will "Detect hallucinations, failed verifications, policy violations, and escalation drivers", due in November.
- Salesforce added evaluations, a "Kill Switch" and hard spending limits to Agent Fabric, its control layer for AI agents, on 27 October.
- Genesys says Trademark Global's AI agent completes 42% of the interactions it handles "without employee assistance". Its assistant for human staff takes the rest.

Workplace AI rules

- **Colorado:** the Attorney General held the hearing on its automated-decision rules on 26 October and took comments only until that night. No final rule has been filed.
- Industry groups, including the US Chamber of Commerce, asked for changes and a delay. Consumer groups asked for stronger rules. The rules are still aimed at 1 January 2027.
- **EU:** we found no enforcement of the ban on emotion recognition at work.
- **California:** more law firms published guidance on the workplace AI laws that start on 1 January 2027. We found no vendor changing a product.
- **UK:** the government has still not responded to its workplace monitoring consultation.
- **Chile:** the Senate's record shows no step on the offshore call-centre bill since 6 May. Chile's national commerce chamber argues a ban could push clients towards automation.

Outsourcers and buyers

- Concentrix launched live voice translation on 27 October, so an advisor and a customer can each speak their own language. Concentrix says it covers more than 60 languages.
- Concentrix says the service delivers "97%+ productivity levels" in real conversations. It gives no baseline.
- Capgemini's third-quarter revenue rose 12.6% to €6,073 million, helped by its WNS purchase. It reports double-digit like-for-like growth in its business operations unit.
- Capgemini's headcount was 417,500, down 5,900 since the end of 2025. It says clients are "transforming their business operations with agentic AI".
- Virgin Media O2 may cut up to 4,000 of its 16,000 UK jobs, Sky News reports. The reports say most are not customer-facing. This is unconfirmed; results are due on 3 November.
- NatWest cut about 1,000 jobs in the third quarter and links the change to AI, Share Talk reports. It did not say which functions.
- NatWest says its AI assistant, Cora, has handled 52,000 credit-card issues. That is a volume, not a resolution rate.

- Pakistan's call-centre and outsourcing exports rose 23.6% to $101.3 million in the July to September quarter, ProPakistani reports, citing central bank data.

Pricing: no move back to seats

- No tracked vendor moved from per-resolution pricing back to per-seat pricing this week.
- Fin's outcome rules became stricter in the buyer's favour. Salesforce, Zendesk, Lorikeet, Microsoft and NiCE list prices were unchanged.
- Genesys renamed its "AI tokens" heading to "Experience Units". Its prices did not change.
- By our count, vendors now price AI work in at least five units: outcomes, conversations, credits, committed minutes and tokens.

Other company developments

- **Uniphore:** its chief executive told CNBC revenue grew about 160% in 12 months, "nearing $2 billion in total bookings". He did not define the bookings figure.
- **Sprinklr:** in a survey it commissioned of 807 US practitioners, 92% said AI met or exceeded expectations. Only 27% said they could measure a result precisely.
- **NiCE:** will report third-quarter results on 4 November. Its annual meeting notice names Gabi Seligsohn as a new board nominee. Ciklum, a London engineering firm, became a NiCE partner in Europe.
- **Results dates:** Five9 reports on 5 November and Zoom on 23 November. Sprinklr and Salesforce have not set dates.
- **Omnichat:** this Hong Kong provider of AI agents on messaging apps raised a $10 million Series A, The Top Voices reports.

Prediction evidence

- No periodic check this week; the next is due in mid-November.
- Microsoft now meters live coaching, and an agent that also helps human representatives, by use.
- **Our view:** after Zendesk's usage-priced translation in September, this is a second exception to the report's view that such help stays in seat prices.

What to watch

- **3 November:** Virgin Media O2's results, with details of any job cuts.

- **4 November:** NiCE's and TaskUs's third-quarter results; Parloa's summit in New York (4 to 5 November).
- **5 November:** Five9, TTEC, Conduent and Genpact results.
- **16 November:** TTEC's loan margin rises unless amended.
- **17 to 20 November:** Microsoft Ignite. Watch for a price list for Contact Center Intelligence and a preview of its Intraday Agent.
- **23 November:** Zoom's results.
- **November:** Microsoft's overdue intraday alerts and its quality checks for AI agents; Salesforce's Australia and New Zealand launch.
- **3 December:** NiCE's annual meeting.
- **18 December:** New York City's hearing and comment deadline on the bot rule.
- **1 January 2027:** California's workplace AI laws and Colorado's target date for its rules.
- **Open:** Decagon's reported sale; Automation Anywhere's Boost.ai deal; a tagged personal-agent protocol release; a beta of Assembled's scheduling agent.
- **New companies surfaced, not yet tracked:** RingCentral (contact centre), Omnichat (messaging AI agents), Ciklum (integrator) and Reindeer AI (agent platform).

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